

and I had a lot to do. Now, I need to earn some money. If you really can't take care of Heidi, then you decide what to do with her. If anything bad happens to her, it's your responsibility."

Deta said more than she planned because she was feeling guilty. The old man stared at her so intensely after she spoke that she stumbled backward a few steps.

He stretched out his arm and yelled, "Go away! Don't come back here anytime soon!" Deta didn't need to be told again. She quickly said goodbye to Heidi and the old man. Then she hurried back down the mountain.

As Deta reached the village, people called out to her. "Where is the child? Where did you leave her, Deta?" And with each question, Deta grew a bit more upset. "I left her up with the Alm-Uncle!" she blurted as she hurried along.

The villagers kept questioning her. "How could you do that? The poor little girl!" Hearing this over and over, Deta felt bad. She remembered her mother's last wish was for her to take care of Heidi. But Deta told herself that she could help Heidi more if she earned some money.

Deta was happy to leave the village behind and the people judging her. She looked forward to her new job, moving faster to get away from all the accusing voices.



With the Grandfather

After Deta left, Grandfather sat back down on the bench. He resumed smoking his pipe while peering down at the ground. Heidi started looking around. She peeked into the goat shed but couldn't see anything inside. Then, she noticed the three old fir trees behind the hut. The wind was making a loud noise as it blew through the trees. Their tops swayed back and forth. Heidi stopped to listen to the sound.

When the wind calmed down a bit, she walked back to her grandfather. He was sitting just as she had left him. Standing in front of him with her arms behind her back, she stared at him. Looking up, Grandfather saw Heidi standing there without moving. "What do you want to do now?" he asked her.

"I want to see what's inside the hut," Heidi responded.

"Come on then," said Grandfather. He stood up and went into the cottage. "Bring your things along," he told her.

"I don't want them anymore," Heidi said.

Grandfather looked at her closely. He could see in her



black eyes that she was excited about what was ahead. “She’s a smart one,” he said to himself. Out loud he asked, “Why don’t you need them anymore?”

“I want to move around like the nimble goats!” Heidi explained.

“Alright, you can do that. But first, go fetch your things. We’ll store them in the cupboard,” he said.

Heidi followed his instructions. The old man opened the door to a large room that filled up the whole hut. There was a table and a chair in one corner, Grandfather’s bed in another, and a big kettle hanging over the fireplace. Heidi followed her grandfather to a big wooden cupboard. This was where he kept his clothes and some dishes. He showed her where to put her things.

On the top shelf of the cupboard, Heidi noticed a loaf of bread, some bacon, and cheese. This was where Grandfather stored all his food. When he opened it, Heidi quickly hid her things as far back as possible behind his clothes. She didn’t want anyone to find them easily.

Looking around the room, Heidi asked, “Where am I going to sleep, Grandfather?”

“Wherever you like,” he answered.

Heidi was happy with this answer and started searching the room. She wanted to find the perfect spot. Next to Grandfather’s bed, she found a ladder. She climbed up to find a hayloft filled with sweet-smelling hay. There was a tiny window through which she could see all the way down to the valley. “I want to sleep up here,” she shouted excitedly. “It’s

*Heidi in her hayloft*

wonderful! Come and see, Grandfather!”

“I know what it’s like,” Grandfather called back from below.

“I’m making the bed right now,” Heidi said, buzzing around the loft. “Please bring up a sheet, Grandfather, because every bed should have one.”

“Is that so?” he replied with a little chuckle. After searching in the cupboard, Grandfather pulled out a long, rough piece of cloth. He took it up to the loft. Heidi was already piling hay to make a comfy bed opposite the window.

Grandfather seemed happy with the setup. To make sure the floor wasn’t too hard, he added even more hay. Together, they put the cloth on the hay bed, tucking in the edges. Heidi then looked at her bed, puzzled, and said, “Grandfather, we forgot something.”

“What did we forget?” he asked.

“A cover. I need something to cover myself up when I sleep,” Heidi explained.

“What can we do if I don’t have one?” Grandfather wondered aloud.

Heidi shrugged, “It’s okay, I’ll just use some hay or maybe we can find something else.” Heidi started toward the heap of hay when the old man stopped her.

“Just wait one minute,” the old man said. He went down to his own bed. He found a large bag made of thick material and brought it back to Heidi.

“Isn’t this better than hay?” he asked.

Heidi struggled to unfold the bag, but the material was



too heavy for her little arms. Grandfather put the thick cover over the bed while Heidi watched him. After it was all done, she said, “What a nice bed I have now! And what a beautiful cover! I wish it were already nighttime so I could go to sleep right away.”

“Let’s eat something first,” Grandfather said. “Don’t you think?”

Heidi had been so focused on her new bed she’d forgotten everything else. But when Grandfather mentioned eating, she realized how hungry she was. She had only had a piece of bread and something to drink early that morning. “I think we should, Grandfather!”

“Let’s go down then,” said the old man.

Grandfather began to prepare to cook the evening meal. In front of the fireplace, he sat down on a three-legged stool. A large kettle was suspended by a chain in the center of the fireplace. Underneath this, he built a bright fire. When the kettle was boiling, the old man fetched a large piece of cheese from the cupboard. He placed this on a long iron fork and held it over the fire. He turned it slowly back and forth until it was golden-brown on all sides.

Heidi watched Grandfather hungrily. Suddenly she ran to the cupboard. When the old man brought a pot and the toasted cheese to the table, he found it already nicely set. Heidi had placed two plates, two knives, and the bread in the middle of the table. She had seen the things in the cupboard before and guessed what they would need to eat their dinner.

“I am glad to see that you can think for yourself,” said



Grandfather. "But something is missing."

Heidi saw the steaming pot and ran back to the cupboard. She pulled down two cups and returned to the table. She filled them with the hot drink from the pot and placed them carefully on the table. "Now everything's ready!" Heidi exclaimed with a bright smile.

Grandfather chuckled and nodded. "You certainly can manage things by yourself. But where will you sit?" Grandfather wondered. He was sitting on the only chair. Heidi dashed to the fireplace and grabbed a tiny stool to sit on.

"You've got a seat, but it's pretty low. But you're too small to reach the table from my chair anyway." Grandfather poured milk into a little bowl. He placed it on his chair near Heidi's stool. This acted as a table for her. He told her to eat the big piece of bread and a slice of yellow cheese. Then, he sat at the corner of the table and began eating too.

Heidi drank her milk quickly because she was very thirsty from her long trip. After finishing, she looked up and took a deep breath.

"How do you like the milk?" asked Grandfather.

"It's the best I've ever had," replied Heidi happily.

"Then have some more," he said, and filled her bowl again.

Heidi enjoyed her meal very much. When they were done eating, they went to the goat shed. Grandfather got busy cleaning and laying fresh straw for the goats. Heidi watched curiously as he worked. Then, he went into a small workshop next door and quickly made a tall chair for Heidi. She was



Grandfather and Heidi enjoy a meal



amazed.

“What do you think?” Grandfather asked.

“It’s a chair for me!” Heidi was impressed. “It’s so high, and you made it so fast!”

“She knows what’s what and keeps her eyes sharp,”

Grandfather thought to himself. He continued fixing things around the house with his hammer and nails. He was busy and happy to have Heidi’s company.

As evening arrived, the wind started to blow through the fir trees, making exciting noises. This delighted Heidi, and she started dancing around joyfully under the trees.

Grandfather watched her from the doorway when suddenly, they heard a loud whistle. It was Peter and the goats coming back from the hills. Heidi was so happy to see her goat friends that she ran to meet them.

When the goats gathered near their little hut, two special goats, one white and one brown, came forward. Grandfather gave them some salt, which he did every night, and Heidi happily petted them. She couldn’t stop asking if the goats were theirs to keep. Grandfather kept saying “yes” to her questions.

After feeding the goats, Grandfather told Heidi to go inside and get her bowl and some bread. Heidi hurried back, and Grandfather milked the white goat for her to have some milk. He also cut her a piece of bread and told her to eat. Then he reminded her that if she needed clothes, she could find them in the cupboard. He said Aunt Deta had left some for her. It was now time to say goodnight as Grandfather



needed to take care of the goats for the night.

“Goodnight, Grandfather! Oh, and what are the goats’ names?” Heidi asked eagerly.

“The white one is Schwänli and the brown one is Bärli,” Grandfather replied.

Heidi felt so happy as she went to bed, thinking about her new friends, Schwänli and Bärli.

“Heidi, come say goodnight to the goats,” called Grandfather. “Goodnight, Schwänli! Goodnight, Bärli,” Heidi shouted to her goat friends as they walked into their shed. Sitting on a bench outside, Heidi quickly ate her supper. The wind was so strong it almost blew her off her seat! She finished eating and hurried inside to go to bed.

Heidi slept well, as comfy as a prince in a fancy bed. Grandfather went to bed early too, as he liked to wake up with the sunrise. The sun rose early in the summer mountains.

That night, the wind was very loud and strong. The little hut shook, the boards creaked, and the chimney roared with the sound of the howling wind. Outside, the big trees swayed back and forth, and some of their dry branches fell to the ground.

In the middle of this noisy night, Grandfather thought Heidi might be scared. So, he climbed up the ladder to check on her. At first, the room was pitch dark. But suddenly, the moon peeked out from behind the clouds and shone brightly on Heidi’s bed. She looked warm and peaceful. Her cheeks were a rosy red as she smiled in her sleep. Perhaps she was



dreaming something lovely.

Grandfather watched her a little while until a cloud covered the moon again. This made everything dark once more. Satisfied that Heidi was fine, he went back downstairs to his own bed.



Heidi sleeps like a princess in a fancy bed

